



India regulating online games

Why is India regulating online games, and what does the Indian gaming industry think about this?

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We recently did a story about the Indian government regulating online games among children. So, here's a follow-up to that piece wherein we discuss why we think the centre is proposing a regulatory framework like this and what the Indian gaming industry thinks about it.

How Is India Planning To Regulate Online Gaming?

The ministry of electronics and information technology (MeitY) has set a panel that is tasked with framing

regulations “against prohibited gaming formats” and mandatory KYC (Know Your Customer) norms for players, among other things. These are reportedly part of a 108-page report drafted on August 31, 2022, and could go into effect by February 2023.



An ET report quotes a government official related to the matter saying, “Addiction (to games) has to be dealt with — whether we do it partly in the IT Rules and partly in the DIA (Digital India Act), it is going to be done”. He also mentioned that since this is a novel issue, it calls for “innovative solutions” and consultation with all the stakeholders such as parents, schools, gaming companies, parents, and adult gamers.

Here are some of the checks and balances suggested:

- Disclosing the time players have spent on each app through usage charts (duration per session). This should be done in a way that doesn't encourage the young players to play more.
- KYC form or other means to verify the age and other details of the players.
- Gaming companies should “host, display, upload, publish, transmit or share an online game” with respect to Indian laws.
- Games that decide betting and gambling based on the outcome are likely to be prohibited soon. So, the regulations could try to keep such games off-limits for children. In Minister of State for Skill Development and Entrepreneurship of India, Rajeev Chandrasekhar's